

Phage Propagation Plaque Assay (Small Scale) Protocol

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To amplify bacteriophage using *Xanthomonas* host bacteria and generate high-titer phage lysate. Used to detect phage and confirm infection.

Materials

- Log-phase Xcc culture ($OD_{600} \approx 0.4-0.6$)
- Phage stock
- NYG soft agar (0.6–0.7%)
- NYG agar plates
- NYG liquid medium
- 30°C incubator

Procedure

1. Mix:
 - 100 μ L log-phase X
 - Serially diluted phage (10–100 μ L)
2. Incubate mixture 10 min at room temperature (adsorption).
 - a. Adsorption is the process by which a bacteriophage attaches to the surface of a bacterial cell before injecting its genetic material.
3. Add 3 mL molten NYG soft agar (cooled to $\sim 40^{\circ}\text{C}$).
4. Pour onto NYG agar plate.
5. Let solidify.
6. Incubate at 30°C overnight.

Plaques should appear as clear zones.

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